

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

60 SECONDS TO READY

01 ANSWER KEY

QUICK REFERENCE

VOCABULARY

1 – D 2 – B 3 – E 4 – A
5 – C

TRUE OR FALSE

1 T 2 T 3 F 4 F 5 T

LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

1 a double-edged sword
2 rallied behind
3 a white elephant
4 came under scrutiny
5 paper over the cracks

TRUE OR FALSE · EVIDENCE

1 the charge is “hard to dismiss” · 2 it is “applied selectively” · 3 the case is “shakier than it looks” · 4 “the unity is real” · 5 passion “can turn ugly”

CRITICAL THINKING · KEEP POLITICS OUT?

No correct rulings. The point is that the principle keeps failing. On 1, is the armband politics, or is banning it? On 2, both banning and admitting the country are political acts. On 4, refusing to play is political, but so is agreeing to. Strong pairs notice that “keep politics out” often just protects whoever is already in charge, and rewrite it more precisely.

02 TEACHER GUIDE

BEFORE CLASS

AIM

Weigh the costs and benefits of hosting, test a principle against hard cases, and defend a position under challenge.

LENGTH

60–75 minutes.

TIP

Keep the debate on principles, not on particular countries. Rejected bidders attack the condition, not the presenters.

EXTENSION

Write a code of conduct for players at the tournament. What does it allow?

03 DISCUSSION NOTES

GUIDE THE TALK

STUDENTS MAY MENTION

sportswashing · hosting costs · empty stadiums · corruption · migrant workers · national identity · nationalism · protest

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS

- Should democratic hosts face the same scrutiny?
- Can national pride exist without nationalism?
- Who should pay: taxpayers, sponsors, or fans?

ENCOURAGE THIS LANGUAGE

“That rests on the assumption that...” · “I’d concede that..., but...” · “The flaw in that argument is...”

04 MODEL WRITING

SAMPLE ANSWER

Few events can make a whole country **rally behind** one team, and that shared experience has real value. For a few weeks, a host nation is seen by billions, and people who rarely agree on anything celebrate together.

Yet the price is often high. Governments spend vast sums on stadiums that later become **a white elephant**, paid for by taxpayers long after the fans have gone home. The money might have built schools or hospitals instead. Hosting can also be used to **paper over the cracks** of a poor human rights record, which is why so many recent hosts have **come under scrutiny**.

The strongest counterargument is that the benefits cannot be measured in money. National pride, a sense of belonging and a new image abroad are real, even if they are hard to count.

I would still largely agree, with one qualification. Hosting is **a double-edged sword**: it can inspire a nation, but the costs usually last longer than the pride. It does more good than harm only when a country builds what it will actually use afterward.